assistance supports community development, agricultural equipment, computers and LED bulbs for schools, dialysis machines, portable saw mills as well as construction of sea wall and coral farms. As noted elsewhere, the level of cooperation is being significantly upgraded as a consequence of the 2023 FIPIC Summit, especially in the domains of health, education and space.

India has responded to natural calamities, including cyclones Yasa, Gita, Hola and Winston, and dispatched vaccines for Covid to Fiji and Nauru bilaterally, as also to Papua New Guinea and Solomon Islands through the COVAX initiative. There is a historical connect in particular with Fiji that can be the foundation of a modern collaboration. All these factors came together at the third FIPIC Summit that was held in Papua New Guinea in 2023.

The Quad nations are all democratic polities, market economies and pluralistic societies. Apart from that natural understanding, similarity in the structural aspects of their relationships has helped to foster the platform. In each case, there are regular bilateral meetings at the summit level, designated formally as annual in the case of Australia and Japan. All the ties now include a 2+2 defence and foreign ministers' interaction. Again, all four countries are members of ASEAN-led forums, including the East Asia Summit, the ASEAN Regional Forum (ARF) and the ASEAN Defence Ministers' Meeting. They also strongly subscribe to the centrality of ASEAN insofar as the Indo-Pacific is concerned. Between them, they are involved in multiple trilateral combinations with other partners, such as Indonesia and France.

In many ways, the ease of working together has been increased by other experiences, whether they are bilateral or more collective. That all of them offer mutual logistics support and work on white shipping obviously enables better maritime security coordination. Their shared view of United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS) 1982 as the constitution of the seas is no less relevant. Similarly, three of them (Japan, Australia and India) being members of the SCRI and the IPOI makes a difference. The working of the Quad takes into account the consequences of globalization and requirements of the global commons. There is undoubtedly a strong shared interest in the oceanic domain as all members are maritime powers. In fact, well before the revival of the Quad, some of them were conducting the Malabar Exercise among themselves. And the